

SMALL AND RARE
Standing just 10 in (25 cm) at the shoulder, the critically endangered pygmy hog is the smallest member of the pig family. Its range is restricted to a national park in northwest Assam, and as few as 150 animals survive.



PYGMY HOG

Home to mugger crocodiles and rare gharials

ICONIC GRASSES

The dominant grasses of the Terai-Duar are actually members of the sugarcane family. Kans grass grows up to 10 ft (3 m) high; baruwa grass is smaller, but both are important food for animals, including the Indian rhinoceros and pygmy hog. The grasses grow quickly after the monsoon rains.

KANS GRASS



REJUVENATING NEWT

The Himalayan newt inhabits streams and paddy fields in the region. It possesses a remarkable ability to regrow lost limbs. Its wounds heal quickly thanks to a peptide called tyiotoin that scientists have isolated from its skin, leading to speculation about its future use in speeding up human wound treatment.

HIMALAYAN NEWT



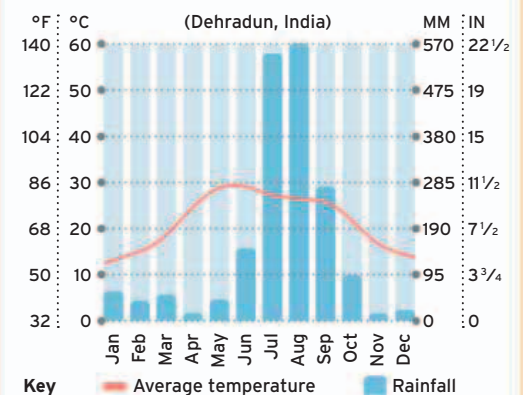
LOCATION

The Terai-Duar savannas are situated in a narrow belt of lowland in front of the Himalayas of southern Asia, where India borders Nepal, Bhutan, and Bangladesh.



CLIMATE

The Terai-Duar has a humid, subtropical climate with year-round warm temperatures averaging 72°F (22°C). Most of the rainfall takes place during the monsoon season, which occurs between June and September.



CULTIVATING CLIMATE CHANGE

Rice is cultivated in the Terai in flooded paddy fields. Microscopic soil organisms in the paddies are a major source of the greenhouse gas methane. Because methane levels increase with rising atmospheric carbon dioxide and warmer temperatures, rice cultivation is likely to fuel global warming. Seasonal drainage of the paddies helps to reduce their methane production.

